



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

vikrīṇīte ya ātmānaṃ svatantraḥ san narādhamah | 05.035a
sa jaghanyataras teṣāṃ naiva dāsyāt pramucyate || 35 || 05.035c
caurāpahṛtavikrītā ye ca dāsīkṛtā balāt | 05.036a
rājñā mokṣayitavyās te dāsatvaṃ teṣu neṣyate || 36 || 05.036c

— Nāradaśmṛti, Chapter 5, Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

These verses from the Nāradaśmṛiti delve into the complexities of servitude, both literal and metaphorical, offering insights that remain relevant even today. The first verse speaks of a "naradhama," a degraded person, who, though independent, sells themselves. This isn't necessarily about physical enslavement but can be seen as sacrificing your inner freedom, your values, and your very soul for worldly gain. It suggests that even in a state of outward autonomy, you can become enslaved to your desires, ego, or societal pressures. Such a person, the text implies, remains bound, never truly free from the consequences of their choice.

The second verse shifts focus to those unjustly enslaved: those stolen, sold against their will, or forced into servitude. The Nāradaśmṛiti asserts that the king, representing just governance, has a duty to liberate these individuals. This highlights the importance of compassion, justice, and the protection of the vulnerable. It also points to the inherent dignity of every human being, regardless of their circumstances. No one should be deprived of their freedom through unjust means, and society has a responsibility to rectify such wrongs.

How does this apply to you today? Consider the ways you might be selling yourself short. Are you chasing external validation at the expense of your inner peace? Are you trapped in a job or relationship that stifles your spirit? Are you allowing fear or insecurity to dictate your choices? The Nāradaśmṛiti urges you to reclaim your inner sovereignty and resist any force, internal or external, that seeks to diminish your true self. Furthermore, it calls upon you to be an advocate for justice and compassion, standing up for those who are oppressed or marginalized in any way. By recognizing the subtle forms of enslavement in your own life and in the world around you, you can actively work towards liberation and cultivate a life of greater freedom, authenticity, and purpose.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

Are there areas in your life where you are compromising your values or autonomy, and what small step can you take today to reclaim your freedom?